Nico Collin

Frontend Tech Lead · Design Systems & Architecture

Open to on-site, hybrid or remote roles

nico.collin.84@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/ncollin

PROFILE

Frontend tech lead with 20+ years of experience, specializing in design systems and frontend architecture. I build complex Vue.js applications, from API contracts to runtime performance. I bridge design and development across teams and brands, using automation and AI to raise team velocity.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nurun — Frontend Tech Lead

Feb 2023 – Present

Digital agency. Leading frontend for a global multi-brand automotive client in a long-term engagement.

- Set frontend vision and architecture for 3 cross-functional Agile squads (15+ people) in collaboration with the backend lead and design lead; co-planned the technical roadmap.
- Engineered an automated Figma-to-code pipeline (tokens, icons, CSS variables) powering theming across 7 brands, reducing design handoff friction and UI inconsistencies across squads.
- Lead the architecture of the main Vue.js application replacing the legacy AngularJS platform, and advocate for a contract-based BFF API layer to decouple the UI from backend services.
- Took over and now lead the framework-agnostic Web Component library implementing the full design system, built on a shared design token structure for a mixed stack (legacy AngularJS, Vue.js, FreeMarker/FTL).
- Introduced AI-assisted workflows (GitHub Copilot, reusable prompts and skills) for documentation and routine coding, with all output reviewed; exploring MCP for team-wide use.
- Mentor the 3 squad leads daily, run structured cross-squad frontend syncs, and created a central documentation portal for best practices and project structure.
- Champion WCAG AA accessibility across all development, working closely with an accessibility expert, and ensure SEO and GEO (AI search bot) compliance.
- Modernized the legacy Gulp build, migrating key processes to Vite, and added local and CI/CD quality gates.
- Drive the migration from Ghost Inspector to Playwright, establishing visual regression testing and unifying QA and developers on one pipeline.

Tecsys — Frontend Tech Lead

Aug 2018 – Feb 2023

Enterprise supply chain platform provider, including healthcare.

- Co-founded Tecsys's first UX team, and created and led its Design System to unify the user experience across the platform and its applications.
- Architected complex Vue.js applications on the Tecsys platform, backed by a contract-based BFF API layer.
- Designed for high-pressure clinical users such as nurses and pharmacists, prioritizing runtime performance, robust error management and efficient workflows where slowdowns or errors were not an option.
- Built the TypeScript Web Component library from scratch, defining its architecture, contribution model and testing.
- Wrote usage and accessibility guidelines and ran weekly design-engineering syncs, speeding onboarding and driving adoption across 3+ product teams.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Nurun — Senior Frontend Developer

Aug 2017 – Aug 2018

- Built a dynamic style guide with components connected to Drupal, working with backend developers to improve UI consistency and delivery speed.
- Led code reviews and unit testing, and mentored junior developers.
- Built UI prototypes to validate design and performance.

Ubisoft — Frontend Tech Lead

Nov 2012 – Aug 2017

- Led frontend for an Assassin's Creed web platform, evolving an interactive lore map into a full gamified experience.
- Built game-to-web features letting players unlock content and complete missions across both.
- Defined the frontend architecture and a shared UI style guide.

Earlier Career

2005 – 2012

Frontend and web integration roles at Cyber Génération, Revolver 3 and WebIntel, building client websites and email templates.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, FreeMarker (FTL)
Frameworks & Libraries	Vue.js (advanced), Lit, Stencil, Web Components, Node.js, React (working knowledge)
Architecture	BFF & Contract-based APIs, Legacy Migration (AngularJS to Vue.js), Runtime Performance, Error Management
Design Systems	Figma, Storybook, Design Tokens, Multi-brand Theming, Custom Component Libraries
Testing & Quality	Playwright, Jest, Visual Regression, Accessibility (WCAG AA), SEO/GEO
Tooling & Workflow	Git, GitLab, Bitbucket, CI/CD, Webpack, Vite, VS Code
AI & Automation	GitHub Copilot, prompt and skill authoring, Model Context Protocol (MCP, exploring)
Collaboration	Agile/Scrum, Mentoring, Documentation & Workshops, Design-to-Dev Alignment
Spoken Languages	French (native), English (fluent; main working language since 2018)

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

College Diploma, Multimedia Integration — Collège de Maisonneuve 2002 – 2005

Certified Experience Designer & Certified Experience Specialist — Akendi 2018 · 2020

Into Design Systems Conference	May 2025
Design System Planning and Process Workshop — Nathan Curtis	Jun 2024
Schema Conference — Figma	Nov 2022
Clarity Conference	Nov 2022
CanUX	Nov 2019
Atomic Design Workshop — Brad Frost	2015